



The Morning Brief

MAY 27, 2026

Chips Lead

S&P and Nasdaq print fresh records as AMD clears \$500 and Micron crosses the \$1 trillion mark; oil retreats despite overnight US strikes on Iran.

S&P 500 (TUE CLOSE)	NASDAQ (TUE CLOSE)	AMD (TUE CLOSE)	BRENT (BNO)	FEAR & GREED
\$750.59 ↑0.66%	\$730.28 ↑1.78%	\$503.89 ↑7.78%	\$53.10 ↓3.45%	25 · Extreme Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Records on Tech Leadership

FRESH ALL-TIME HIGHS ON THE S&P AND NASDAQ AS THE AI MEMORY CYCLE RATCHETS — TECH ↑2.63% AGAINST ENERGY -2.76% MARKS A NOTABLY WIDE SECTOR SPREAD

Tuesday’s session resolved the constructive futures setup the prior brief flagged into a tape-led advance in semiconductors and small caps. SPY closed at \$750.59 (↑0.66%) and the Nasdaq proxy at \$730.28 (↑1.78%) on fresh records, with the Russell 2000 leading at \$290.51 (↑1.89%); the Dow lagged at \$505.25 (−0.17%) as the index’s industrial and energy weight diluted the chip-led gains. Sector breadth narrowed in a constructive way: Tech (XLK ↑2.63%), Industrials (XLI ↑1.47%), and Materials (XLB ↑1.39%) carried the leadership, while Energy (XLE −2.76%) and Staples (XLP −1.38%) lagged on the peace-progression trade. The single-stock catalyst was outside the IOWN sleeve: per CNBC, Micron Technology jumped 19% to cross \$1 trillion in market capitalization for the first time after UBS raised its target to \$1,625 from \$535, citing HBM4 capacity sold out through year-end and long-term agreement economics replacing commodity pricing across the memory complex. The read-through to the IOWN semiconductor and AI-power sleeves was immediate and broad. The UVXY (VIX proxy) closed at \$31.41 (−4.56%), TLT added 0.50%, and Fear & Greed slipped to 25 (Extreme Fear) — the gap between the record-print tape and the sentiment gauge has now widened, not narrowed, over the multi-day rally.

S&P / NASDAQ / DOW (TUE)	\$750.59 ↑0.66% · \$730.28 ↑1.78% · \$505.25 ↓0.17%
RUSSELL 2000 (TUE)	\$290.51 · ↑1.89% · small-cap leadership
SECTOR SPREAD	XLK ↑2.63% · XLI ↑1.47% · XLB ↑1.39% · XLE ↓2.76% · XLP ↓1.38%
VIX PROXY · BONDS	UVXY \$31.41 ↓4.56% · TLT \$85.10 ↑0.50%
CARSON’S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY \$645.80 support · Untested (Tue low \$748.37)
FEAR & GREED	25 · Extreme Fear · gap to tape widens

AMD CLEARS \$500 (↑7.78%), LRCX ↑5.68%, ADI ↑5.76%, MRVL ↑6.08% INTO TONIGHT’S PRINT — THE MEMORY READ-THROUGH EXTENDED ACROSS THE IOWN SEMICONDUCTOR SLEEVE ACROSS THE DAY

Tuesday’s leadership inside the IOWN sleeves was broad-based across the chip stack rather than concentrated in a single name. AMD closed at \$503.89 (↑7.78%), clearing the \$500 mark on the session, with Yahoo Finance noting the stock’s market capitalization now sits near JPMorgan’s. Lam Research finished at \$322.68 (↑5.68%) as the memory capex implication of Micron’s HBM4 read-through flowed directly into the wafer-fab equipment line. Analog Devices added

5.76% to \$419.94, NXPI gained 5.12% to \$332.67, QCOM extended 4.48% to \$248.82 on follow-through from the Stellantis Snapdragon expansion, Keysight rose 2.65% to \$355.74, TSM added 1.93% to \$412.32, and TEL gained 2.87% to \$208.60. In the AI-power line, VST closed at \$164.56 (↑5.30%) and HUT at \$112.54 (↑6.27%). Marvell finished at \$208.26 (↑6.08%) heading into its fiscal Q1 print after today's close (consensus near \$0.81 per share). The breadth of the bid — wafer-fab equipment, analog, power, connectivity, and digital design all in the same column — is the signal the AI infrastructure thesis was built to capture.

The physical world matters.

ENERGY SLEEVE CARRIED THE OTHER SIDE OF THE TAPE — XLE -2.76% AS BRENT AND WTI SOLD OFF THROUGH THE PEACE HEADLINES, WITH CVX -3.51% AND OKE -3.82% INSIDE THE IOWN LINEUP

The peace-progression trade that the prior brief described as compressing Brent toward \$96 extended into a hard down-

day across the energy complex on Tuesday despite overnight US strikes on Iranian vessels. Brent (BNO) closed at \$53.10 (-3.45%) and WTI (USO) at \$137.00 (-2.78%); the IOWN energy positions tracked the move — CVX at \$184.71 (-3.51%), OKE at \$90.44 (-3.82%), VLO at \$241.45 (-2.23%), CNX at \$34.73 (-1.64%). The market is pricing the framework as more durable than the strikes — a directional bet that may be tested if the Iran retaliation language hardens into action through Wednesday. The integrated and downstream profile of CVX and VLO diversifies the sleeve's exposure to a sustained Brent decline relative to the upstream-and-gas concentration, but a one-day -2.76% XLE move with no equivalent rally in defense (LMT -0.06%, GD ↑0.51%) suggests positioning is leaning toward the peace outcome rather than hedging the tail. Discipline through the transition window tends to weigh both sides rather than chase the consensus posture.

A fresh-record tape on AI memory leadership, an energy sleeve absorbing the peace-progression sell, and a calendar that loads MRVL after today's close, PCE before tomorrow's open, and Dell after tomorrow's close — three single-session catalysts inside thirty-six hours. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics

US STRIKES IRAN VESSELS AND MISSILE SITES OVERNIGHT TUESDAY, IRAN'S IRGC VOWS TO RETALIATE — CAMP DAVID CABINET MEETING RELOCATED TO THE WHITE HOUSE AS THE FRAMEWORK ENTERS A PRESSURE-TESTED PHASE

The peace track that President Trump described over the weekend as proceeding constructively ran into its first material test overnight. Per CNBC reporting, US Central Command confirmed self-defense strikes in southern Iran early Tuesday local time targeting vessels allegedly attempting to deploy mines and several missile launch locations. Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps stated it would retaliate against violations of the ceasefire, per the same coverage. President Trump initially scheduled a rare Cabinet meeting at Camp David for Wednesday to discuss the framework; per CNBC and CBS reporting, the meeting was relocated to the White House Tuesday afternoon, with the administration citing weather conditions. A separate friction point hardened around the Strait of Hormuz: Iran's Foreign Ministry signaled that navigation through the strait would carry costs, raising the prospect of transit fees that the contemplated framework had described as toll-free. The market read on Tuesday is that the framework remains intact enough to compress Brent another 3.45% on the BNO proxy — oil is pricing the strikes as inside the negotiation rather than outside it — but the seams the prior brief flagged on Hormuz control, frozen assets, and the nuclear scope are now joined by an active retaliation threat.

THE IOWN ENERGY SLEEVE IS SITTING AT THE SPREAD BETWEEN THE TWO NARRATIVES — A CONFIRMED FRAMEWORK COMPRESSES THE PREMIUM FURTHER; A HARDENED RETALIATION RE-PRICES THE TAIL WITH NO EQUIVALENT HEDGE IN DEFENSE ON TUESDAY'S TAPE

The energy sleeve's Tuesday move — XLE -2.76%, CVX -3.51%, OKE -3.82%, VLO -2.23%, CNX -1.64% — sits against a defense line that did not bid back the difference (LMT -0.06%, GD ↑0.51%). The asymmetry warrants attention: the market is positioned for the framework to hold, not for the strikes-plus-retaliation path to become the operative scenario. Per Wood Mackenzie commentary previously referenced, a confirmed Hormuz reopening within the sixty-day window could point spot Brent toward \$80 by year-end as the war-risk premium unwinds; per Goldman Sachs commentary, the late-2026 view sits closer to \$90 if disruption proves more persistent. The IOWN sleeve's construction was around the “physical world matters” thesis of constrained capacity and supply discipline rather than around the escalation path itself — the integrated (CVX) and downstream (VLO) names diversify the exposure relative to the upstream-and-gas concentration, and the midstream line (OKE) carries fee-based cash generation through the transition. Defense exposure (LMT, GD) retains its orthogonal-hedge role even with Tuesday's flat tape; a sixty-day ceasefire is not a permanent retirement of the underlying risk, and the cabinet meeting being relocated rather than postponed signals an

administration treating the negotiation as live rather than concluded. **Avoid Erosion.**

US ACTION (TUE OVERNIGHT)	CENTCOM strikes on Iranian vessels and missile sites per CNBC
IRAN RESPONSE	IRGC vows retaliation · Foreign Ministry signals Hormuz transit costs
CABINET MEETING (WED)	Camp David relocated to White House per CBS/CNBC · cited as weather
BRENT (BNO) · WTI (USO)	\$53.10 ↓3.45% · \$137.00 ↓2.78% · peace-progression bid
IOWN ENERGY (TUE)	CVX ↓3.51% · OKE ↓3.82% · VLO ↓2.23% · CNX ↓1.64%
DEFENSE (TUE)	LMT ↓0.06% · GD ↑0.51% · no equivalent hedge bid

On Our Radar

1. Marvell reports fiscal Q1 after today's close — the IOWN AI-connectivity print into a chip tape that ratcheted ↑6.08% in front of the conference call. Per the consensus survey embedded in the earnings calendar, the print expects roughly \$0.81 per share. MRVL closed at \$208.26 on Tuesday, with the day's range stretching from \$200.04 to \$217.45 — the volatility is consistent with a market positioning around the AI-optical and custom-silicon thesis. The Marvell read is the first IOWN-side test of whether the Micron memory cycle and the broader chip leadership extend through earnings or stop at sentiment. A constructive print would extend the leadership into Friday's open; an in-line read against the Tuesday rally could produce a sell-the-news compression even on a clean beat. *Think Like an Owner.*

2. Thursday's 8:30 AM ET tape carries the April PCE Deflator and the second Q1 GDP estimate — the gating macro read into Warsh's first FOMC meeting in June. Per the BEA release schedule, the April Personal Income and Outlays report releases at 8:30 AM ET on May 28 alongside the second GDP estimate. Per the consensus survey referenced in our coverage, headline PCE is expected near 3.9% year over year (with a roughly 0.5% monthly print) and core PCE near 3.3% (a roughly 0.3% monthly print), driven partly by the energy pass-through from the Middle East shock. A hotter read would extend the no-cut-in-2026 path; an in-line print may keep the rate-sensitive sleeves (utilities, REIT-adjacent exposure, TOL through the homebuilder line) range-bound. Today's economic calendar carries scheduled remarks from Dallas Fed President Lorie Logan ahead of the print, per the data drop schedule. *Avoid Erosion.*

3. Dell reports fiscal Q1 2027 results Thursday after the close — the AI-server bellwether reaches the tape inside the same session as PCE and GDP.

Per the Dell investor calendar, the print releases May 28 after market close with the conference call after the bell. Per the company's prior guidance, Q1 revenue is expected in the \$34.7–\$35.7 billion range with roughly \$13 billion of AI-server revenue, and Polymarket prediction markets cited in our coverage price approximately 94% odds of a beat against the \$2.95 non-GAAP EPS consensus. The \$43 billion AI-server backlog is the disclosure to watch. A constructive read — particularly a raised full-year guide alongside the Q1 beat — would extend the data-center capital cycle thesis carrying VST, NEE, LRCX, TSM, and CRDO into Friday's open. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. AMD clearing \$500 on a ↑7.78% session to \$503.89 is a single-stock confirmation point inside the broader memory-cycle read.

Per Yahoo Finance coverage, AMD's market capitalization on Tuesday's close approaches JPMorgan's. The catalyst was the read-through from Micron's \$1 trillion milestone — UBS raised its Micron target to \$1,625 from \$535 on HBM4 capacity sold out through year-end and long-term agreement economics replacing commodity pricing. The implication for the IOWN sleeve is that the AI infrastructure thesis is broadening from the data-center connectivity layer (CRDO, MRVL) into the broader compute and memory complex. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. CRDO's Tuesday tape (↑1.48% to \$221.64 with an intraday high of \$233.70) shows the print premium narrowing into next Monday's fiscal Q4 release.

Per the consensus survey referenced in our coverage, normalized EPS expectations sit near \$1.03 and revenue near \$433 million for the June 1 print. The implied earnings move is wide, and the DustPhotonics acquisition is the focal point alongside the AI connectivity demand trajectory. CRDO's Tuesday session range spanned roughly 10% intraday — the option-implied volatility is consistent with the market pricing a meaningful update on the AI-optical revenue trajectory. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. Fear & Greed slipped to 25 (Extreme Fear) even as the S&P and Nasdaq printed fresh records on Tuesday — the gap between price and positioning has now widened through a full week of broad green tape.

The reading was 30 (Fear) heading into Tuesday's open and now sits five points lower despite the ↑0.66% S&P print and the ↑1.78% Nasdaq move. Historically, sentiment readings of this magnitude at record-tape levels have tended to compress as the positioning gap closes — either through the tape giving back gains or through the sentiment gauge re-rating higher on a confirmed catalyst. The IOWN philosophy

frame remains discipline through positioning extremes rather than chasing the consensus posture. **The physical world matters.**